



Conversation Starters

A shuffled deck of prompts for a one-to-one or small-group check-in. A student picks a card at random, and you talk about whatever it asks. There is no script beyond that, and no answer is wrong. Over time it is how a student gets used to talking to you.

Print these

Page	What it is
Pages 2 and 3	The twenty-four cards, twelve to a page. Cut one set along the dashed lines and shuffle them.

How it works

Step	What happens
1	Give the cards a proper shuffle, so nobody, including you, knows which one is coming next.
2	A student pulls one card at random and reads it aloud, or hands it to you to read for them.
3	Let the conversation go wherever the prompt takes it. There is no right answer and no need to rush on, and if a card does not fit that day they can skip it and pick again.
4	One card is enough for a quick check-in. Work through several for a longer conversation.

Worth knowing

- It takes as little as two minutes, or as long as the conversation needs.
- Keep the deck wherever your check-ins tend to happen: a desk drawer, a folder, a coat pocket. The same set lasts all year, and you can add cards of your own over time.

The only preparation is one round of cutting.





Conversation Starter Cards

Cut along the dashed lines. Shuffle before first use.

 CONVERSATION STARTER What’s one thing that made you smile this week?	 CONVERSATION STARTER Who’s someone that’s been there for you lately?	 CONVERSATION STARTER What’s something you’re looking forward to?
 CONVERSATION STARTER If today had a soundtrack, what would be playing?	 CONVERSATION STARTER What’s been the best part of your week so far?	 CONVERSATION STARTER What’s something small that’s been bothering you?
 CONVERSATION STARTER If you could swap one thing about today, what would it be?	 CONVERSATION STARTER What’s a place where you feel completely comfortable?	 CONVERSATION STARTER What’s something you’re proud of, even if it feels small?
 CONVERSATION STARTER Who makes you laugh the most, and why?	 CONVERSATION STARTER What’s one word for how you’re feeling right now?	 CONVERSATION STARTER What’s something you wish more people understood about you?



Conversation Starter Cards (continued)

Cut along the dashed lines. Shuffle before first use.

 CONVERSATION STARTER If you had a free hour right now, what would you do with it?	 CONVERSATION STARTER What's something that's felt harder than usual lately?	 CONVERSATION STARTER What's a small thing someone could do to make your day better?
 CONVERSATION STARTER What's something you're curious about at the moment?	 CONVERSATION STARTER What helps you feel calm when things get busy?	 CONVERSATION STARTER What's a change you've noticed in yourself this year?
 CONVERSATION STARTER What's something you're grateful for today?	 CONVERSATION STARTER If you could talk to anyone for advice, who would it be?	 CONVERSATION STARTER What's a goal you're working towards right now?
 CONVERSATION STARTER What's something that surprised you recently?	 CONVERSATION STARTER What's one thing you'd like to get better at?	 CONVERSATION STARTER What's something you need right now that you haven't asked for?